

Theories and Practices of Nationalism (HS3.303)

Mid Sem Exam

Max. Time: 90 mins

Max. Marks: 60

06 Feb 2026

Section A

Answer any two questions; $2 \times 15 = 30$ marks; approx. 500 words each

✓ **Question 1.** Discuss the claim: Nationalism comes before nations.

✓ **Question 2.** Is nationalism primarily a political principle, a cultural artefact, or an instrument of social transformation?

✓ **Question 3.** How have different scholars seen the role of schools and education in the development of nationalism?



Section B

All questions are compulsory; $6 \times 5 = 30$ marks; about 3 sentences each

✓ **Question 1.** What does Benedict Anderson mean when he defines the nation as an "imagined political community"?

✓ **Question 2.** According to Ernest Gellner, why was nationalism impossible in pre-modern agrarian societies?

✓ **Question 3.** Define "invented tradition".

✓ **Question 4.** What is the difference between E H Carr's and Eric Hobsbawm's three phases of nationalism?

✓ **Question 5.** Who says that nations get their history wrong, and why does he say that?

✓ **Question 6.** According to Benedict Anderson, what is the warp and weft of the national cloth?